

CoinPicks Market Direction

Research Package

Five pillars — four researched narratives and one pure-math read of the Bitcoin chart — scored on one standard, blended into one table, and distilled to one number. Everything in this folder is current as of **September 26, 2026** — a FULL WEEKLY refresh, left as a **DRAFT awaiting Alex's stamp**, measured against the Sept 23 committed baseline (2026-09-23_draft).

DRAFT — NOT STAMPED. SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-26_draft3). Full weekly refreshes are *categorically* excluded from the delegated auto-stamp authority in CLAUDE.md — the weekly is Alex's own review checkpoint — so this one waits for a human, regardless of how well sourced it is. **Three pillars moved and they largely offset.** Fed & Macro was cut (31/29/37/44/58 → 27/25/34/43/58) on a week of hawkish evidence that is mostly primary-sourced. Iran War Risk split by window (3/3/16/35/66 → 1/2/15/34/66) on Iran's foreign minister putting a seven-day Hormuz-reopening plan on the record. Tokenization was cut a point on the near window (58/65/70/77/86 → 57/65/70/77/86) because the pillar's own pre-committed trigger fired downward. CLARITY Act held flat, but four errors in its fact record were corrected — including one where the report said the opposite of a primary source. **Note that TWO independent weekly refreshes ran today** — a cloud run pushed its own Sept 26 sets first, so this package is score set 2026-09-26_draft3; the two agree closely on Fed & Macro and differ on Iran and Tokenization. \1 this cycle supersedes an interrupted Sept 24 cycle that was never delivered yet whose reports claimed a stamp that was never written; and the leave-one-out range still changes sign depending on which single pillar you remove, so the headline is fragile by construction.

THE FINAL NUMBER · SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 (DRAFT — NOT STAMPED, FULL WEEKLY REFRESH, 2026-09-26_DRAFT3) · BTC \$84,015.60 ON SEPT 26

−0.08 **Neutral** — essentially flat, having crossed zero without changing call band

Equal-weight mean of the five window signals below — every pillar counts 20% (scale −10 to +10). The headline reads −0.08 equal-weight, from +0.02 on Sept 23; the horizon-weighted variant reads **+0.47**, down from +0.55 — which drops it out of Mild Bull into **Neutral**. **Three of the four qualitative pillars moved this cycle** — Fed & Macro down, Iran War Risk split by window, Tokenization down a point on 1mo; only CLARITY Act held flat. The computed Bitcoin TA read ticked down with BTC's move from \$85,488.24 to \$84,015.60. **Two call bands flipped** (3 months Mild Bear → Bear, 6 months Neutral → Mild Bear) plus a third on the horizon-weighted final number itself (Mild Bull → Neutral). The first two are boundary crossings of 0.15 and 0.11; the third matters more, because it is the headline long-money read losing its bullish tilt.

THE FIVE WINDOWS UNDERNEATH IT

WINDOW	MASTER SIGNAL	CALL
1 month	-2.15	Bear — weaker, from -1.95. Fed & Macro fell to -3.13 on the week’s hawkish bundle and Iran slipped to -4.70 as every on-record actor put a deal past this window; unusually, Tokenization (+1.01) eased too, so nothing offset the drag. CLARITY (-4.76) is still the single biggest weight
3 months	-1.63	Bear — from -1.48, and the call band flipped from Mild Bear on a move of 0.09 across the 1.5 boundary. Fed fell to -3.40, the cycle’s largest single pillar move
6 months	-0.59	Mild Bear — from -0.48, the second band flip (Neutral → Mild Bear) on a 0.05 move across the 0.50 boundary. Fed fell to -2.05; Iran firmed to -3.92
1 year	+1.15	Mild Bull — essentially unchanged from +1.18. Tokenization leads at +3.37, alongside CLARITY (+3.17) and Bitcoin TA (+1.73)
3 years	+2.82	Bull — unchanged, every pillar still positive. Nothing this cycle reached the multi-year windows

Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. The leave-one-out range this cycle is -0.76 to +0.59 — the sign flips positive (Mild Bull) when Iran War Risk is dropped (+0.59), and **dropping Tokenization alone pushes the reading to -0.76, Mild Bear**. With the headline at -0.08, removing any single pillar swings it by far more than the number itself. That is the honest state of the blend — see the Master Report’s Robustness section.

Reading order

Twenty minutes to the whole picture; each report stands alone and can be checked independently — every fact is dated with sources on its last page.

#	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	CoinPicks_Master_Direction_Report.pdf	The summary. The final number, the five-window table, the full pillar matrix, where the lenses agree/fight, six weeks of dated triggers, sensitivity.
2	CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report.pdf	The math pillar. 7 indicators on 16 years of data, halving-cycle analogs, power-law valuation — with charts. Fully reproducible from code.
3	reports/current/pdf/ — the four pillar PDFs	The story pillars. CLARITY Act · Iran War Risk · Tokenization RWA · Fed & Macro. Each: thesis, dated facts, honest bear case, dated triggers, and the full score lineage (June committed → ... → Sept 23 committed → Sept 26 draft, this version).
4	reports/archive/ + prior-work/	Every earlier version, preserved untouched — the score history is fully auditable.
—	run.py · engine/blend.py · data/master_blend.json	The blend engine (runnable Python — reproduce any score set with <code>run.py blend --set NAME</code>), its output, and README.md for regeneration.

How the scoring works — one paragraph

Every pillar answers the same question on five windows (1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 1 year / 3 years): **P** = the odds (0–100) that this force is *good for crypto* by then, **Quality** = how trustworthy the evidence is (0–1), and **Impact** = how hard this force moves the whole market (0–10). These combine into a **Signal** = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$ (Impact is a uniform 8 for every pillar), so a coin-flip view scores zero no matter how loud the headlines are, and weak evidence can't shout. **All five pillars are equal-weighted** — the master for each window is the simple mean of the five signals (20% each; add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N) — and the Final Number averages the five master windows.

The five pillars at a glance (FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 26 — score set 2026-09-26_draft3, DRAFT, awaiting Alex's stamp)

PILLAR	1MO	3MO	6MO	1YR	3YR	ONE-LINE READ
CLARITY Act (law)	15	28	45	72	92	Held flat — nothing cleared the sufficiency bar, and senate.gov confirms one session week left before a five-week recess. But FOUR fact corrections: the final text DOES require divest-or-blind-trust (the report had said the opposite), Tillis not Thune filed the motion to reconsider, and four Republicans defected on the vote
Iran War Risk	2	5	18	36	66	RE-RATED DOWN from 3/3/16/35/66, reversing the Sept 23 bump. Araghchi put a seven-day Hormuz-reopening plan on the record Sept 25 — and Trump rejected it on the record himself on Sept 26 ("I reject their proposal"). An earlier draft of this cycle had scored the plan as a positive; that was withdrawn. Not a full reversal, because Trump also said "I like making a deal too" and Pezeshkian offered to readmit UN nuclear inspectors
Tokenization (RWA)	57	65	70	77	86	CUT one point on 1mo from 58. This pillar's own pre-committed trigger fired DOWNWARD : tokenized US Treasuries \$14.94B, −6.95% over 30 days, a third consecutive negative reading. The CFTC's Sept 24 tokenized-collateral FAQ offsets the longer windows
Fed & Macro	27	25	34	43	58	RE-RATED DOWN from 31/29/37/44/58, the largest move. Barr's Sept 23 speech verbatim from the Fed's own PDF, the flash PMI's fastest input costs since Oct 2022, UMich long-run inflation expectations 3.3%→3.4%, claims near 57-year lows, and reserves −\$83.6B in a week
Bitcoin TA (quant)	57	60	61	68	68	Computed, unchanged methodology (BTC \$84,015.60, Sept 26, down from \$85,488.24 Sept 23). Full local quant refresh this cycle (run.py quant): prices fetched, indicators, levels, cycle and charts all recomputed

P values shown (50 = coin flip). All four qualitative pillars were researched from primary sources this cycle, then the load-bearing claims were re-derived independently in two adversarial-verification passes. Three pillars moved; CLARITY Act held flat on the score while four errors in its fact record were corrected. The Bitcoin TA pillar is computed by the pipeline and never hand-edited.

Status & honesty notes

- **Score status — today is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, and it is NOT stamped.** One new score set, 2026-09-26_draft3, measured against the Sept 23 committed baseline (2026-09-23_draft). **Three pillars re-rated** — Fed & Macro down (31/29/37/44/58 → 27/25/34/43/58), Iran War Risk split by window (3/3/16/35/66 → 1/2/15/34/66), Tokenization down a point on 1mo (58/65/70/77/86 → 57/65/70/77/86). **One held flat** (CLARITY Act). Per CLAUDE.md, full weekly refreshes are *categorically* excluded from the delegated auto-stamp authority — independent of how large the moves are or how good the sourcing is — because the weekly is Alex's own review checkpoint. Status in config/scores.json: draft, stamped_by: null.
- **Read this first if you read nothing else: an earlier cycle was interrupted, and it matters for trust.** A Sept 24 cycle wrote a score set and edited all six reports, but was never rendered, selfchecked, archived or committed — and its report text nonetheless asserted "COMMITTED · AUTO-STAMPED" in every decision stamp for a set that was still draft in the data file. run.py selfcheck catches exactly that, and did, twelve times. This cycle treats it as not-delivered (the house rule for abandoned drafts), independently re-verifies its claims instead of trusting them, and drops it from the visible lineage while leaving it in scores.json forever. **The re-verification cut both ways:** its two Fed claims held up in full, its Iran claim was falsified on a point of fact, and its Tokenization judgement was found one-sided and is reversed here.
- **Heads-up before you compare notes: TWO independent weekly refreshes ran for today, and three score sets carry today's date.** The cloud routine researches the day on its own unless it can already see the day's commit on the shared repo — this run's commit was still local when it went, so it ran independently and pushed first. Its sets are 2026-09-26_draft (a daily cycle, committed and auto-stamped) and 2026-09-26_draft2 (its own weekly); this package is 2026-09-26_draft3. Nothing of the cloud's was edited or overwritten. **The good news:** on Fed & Macro the two independent passes landed within a point of each other on every window — the cloud read **27/25/35/43/57** against this package's **27/25/34/43/58**, identical on the 1-month, 3-month and 1-year windows. Two separate primary-source passes converging that tightly is genuine corroboration of the biggest move this cycle, and it is reported rather than averaged away. **What Alex needs to settle:** they disagree on Iran (how far to reverse) and on Tokenization (whether to cut the near window), and on which set becomes the canonical weekly. This one is the set with the adversarial verification behind it.
- **Why Fed & Macro moved most, so you can judge it yourself.** Not one headline — a week, and mostly primary sources. Fed Governor Michael Barr, Sept 23, in a speech whose text was extracted from the Fed's own PDF: "inflation is above our 2 percent target and not clearly trending toward target in a timely way" and "in my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed." The S&P Global flash US PMI, from the embargoed release: strongest private-sector growth since July 2021 *paired with* the fastest input-cost inflation since October 2022. The University of Michigan's final September survey: year-ahead inflation expectations 4.0% → 4.6% and, more importantly, *long-run* expectations 3.3% → 3.4%, breaking three straight months — that is the de-anchoring risk that extends a tightening cycle past one meeting. Plus jobless claims at 197,000 (near 57-year lows) and Fed reserve balances down \$83.6B in a single week. **Honest counterweight:** growth is strong, layoffs are historically low, new home sales rose, and the reserve drain is largely a mechanical Treasury-account rebuild — which is why the cut is single-digit and barely touches the 1-year and 3-year windows.
- **Why Iran War Risk went both ways at once.** Iran's foreign minister, Abbas Araghchi, stood outside the UN Security Council on Sept 25 and put a specific seven-day plan on the record, conveyed via Qatar: the US lifts the blockade, waives oil sanctions and releases an estimated \$12bn in frozen assets over about four to five days, the Strait of Hormuz reopens on day six, and nuclear talks begin on day seven. That is a named official on the record, carried by AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera independently — a real upgrade over the anonymous sourcing of previous weeks. Because the midterms are Nov 3, a post-election deal falls *outside* the 1-month window and *inside* the 3- and 6-month ones, so those windows move in opposite directions. **The move is deliberately small, because the up-move rests on statements while the confirmed actions run the other way:** a cargo vessel was struck in Hormuz on Sept 23 with two casualties, Saudi Arabia was fired on twice, the naval blockade is intact, Hormuz traffic is still only about 9–18 ships a day against roughly 125 before the war, and Brent is back above \$100.

- **Why Tokenization was cut even though it had good news.** Months ago this pillar wrote down a specific promise: a third consecutive negative reading on tokenized US Treasuries “would be a genuine trend worth re-rating on.” It got one — \$14.94B, down 6.95% over 30 days, after two smaller declines, roughly seven times the previous magnitude. Acting on a trigger you committed to in advance is the whole point of writing it down, so the near window came down a point. The abandoned Sept 24 draft had gone the *other* way on a New York Stock Exchange / Blockchain.com agreement; that agreement is real, but it is non-binding, needs regulatory approval, has no launch date, and the venue is not live — and this pillar’s own standard says the trigger is a venue actually going live. Taking the good news while ignoring the bad would have been one-sided.
- **Why CLARITY held flat — and what was wrong in the last report.** Nothing new cleared the bar, and the Senate has one session week left (Sept 28 – Oct 2) before a five-week recess with no re-vote scheduled. But four things in the fact record needed fixing, and one was serious: **the report stated the opposite of a primary source.** It said the final bill text does *not* require divestment or a blind trust; Senator Lummis’s own summary of that text says there is a “clear requirement for covered individuals to divest significant financial interests or place in a qualified blind trust.” The honest version is that the requirement is real but delayed. Also fixed: the stablecoin-yield fight is not unresolved (the text has a Treasury circuit breaker that expires 18 months after enactment); Senator Tillis, not Senator Thune, filed the motion to reconsider; and the report never mentioned that *four Republicans* voted against cloture, which is a harder read than blaming the failure entirely on Democrats.
- **What was deliberately NOT counted, in both directions.** This is where the rules earn their keep. A Wall Street Journal report that Trump *rejected* Iran’s seven-day plan rests on unnamed officials in a single outlet, with everyone else citing the WSJ and no on-record White House position — so it was reported but not scored, even though it argues *against* the up-move taken here. Also reported but not scored: a 60-day “road map” story that is still single-sourced; the Pentagon’s 19th US death, which is non-hostile and therefore does not fire the combat-death trigger; prediction-market odds on CLARITY (6.45%, on \$12,700 of daily volume — an effectively dead market) and on the midterms, which are market prices, not institutional forecasts, and are never mixed with them; and a new BlackRock-strategy tokenized product that is restricted to non-US investors, the same ground on which two earlier launches were excluded.
- **Verification, and one finding worth knowing:** every load-bearing new claim was re-derived from primary sources in two adversarial passes, deliberately not trusting the research’s own citations — and they overturned findings in *both* directions, restoring two claims that had been wrongly “corrected” and falsifying three that had been accepted. Along the way: the automated page-fetching tool was caught failing silently on PDFs and very large files, both denying a sentence that was really there and reporting numbers a source does not contain. Verbatim quotes from PDFs in this system now require local text extraction. Two facts could not be primary-verified because their sources block automated access — the Sept 23 Hormuz vessel strike and the “no US strikes since Sept 1” status — and both are labelled as wire-derived rather than presented as primary. Neither drives a score change on its own.
- **Known limits, in print inside the reports:** cycle-analog claims rest on 3 completed cycles ($n=3$), so direction is the signal and levels are soft; the current weekly, monthly and quarterly bars are PARTIAL and the completed-bar composites are quoted alongside them; the power-law fair value (\$141,272, about 41% above today’s price) swings with its fit window, so it is quoted as a range (\$119k–\$146k across 2011–2015 start years) and never as a target; the quant pillar’s P is capped at 50 ± 25 by design because measured technical edge is modest, and a 5-feature crash model that failed out-of-sample (AUC 0.44) stays excluded; froth data lags about six weeks and is a robustness tilt only, never a score input.
- **The near-term calendar, in order of what actually matters:** August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate land **Sept 30** — the first hard inflation data since the three Fed communications behind this cycle’s biggest move, and the first real test of it · the Senate’s last pre-recess week, Sept 28 – Oct 2 · whether the US answers Iran’s seven-day plan on the record · whether any venue actually goes live under the SEC’s tokenized-stock exemption, and whether tokenized Treasuries fall for a fourth reading · the Oct 27–28 FOMC.

This is research and education, not financial advice. The scores are probabilistic opinions with dated evidence — built to be argued with. If you check one thing manually, check any pillar's What Changed section this cycle — each ran independent fresh research and is honest about finding nothing that cleared the bar, rather than manufacturing a move. The Iran War Risk pillar's trigger table is worth a look too: it flags the next scheduled US-Iran meeting as the clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.